Why Teenagers Need More Sleep

Sleep is essential for learning. During sleep, the brain replays and strengthens the memories formed during the day, a process known as memory consolidation. Students who sleep well after studying remember significantly more than those who stay up late.

Teenagers face a particular challenge. During puberty, the body clock shifts later, so teenagers naturally feel sleepy around two hours later than adults. The American Academy of Pediatrics recommends that middle and high schools start no earlier than 8:30 a.m. to allow for this.

Despite this, most teenagers do not get enough sleep. Experts recommend eight to ten hours a night for 13 to 18 year olds, yet surveys show that the majority of high school students sleep less than eight hours on school nights.

Personally, I think schools should start later. It would help students concentrate and would probably improve exam results too.